

April

28



224 CE

Battle of Hormozdgān

Sasanian king Ardashīr I defeated the Parthian king Artabanus V and set up the Sasanian Empire in ancient Persia. He went on to become one of Persia's greatest rulers, and his empire lasted more than 400 years.

Also on this day

1869 Chinese and Irish workers set a record by laying more than 16 km (10 miles) of the Pacific Railroad in the USA in one day.

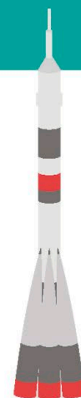
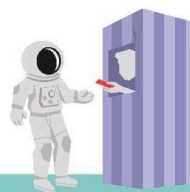
1952 The US occupation of Japan after World War II ended when the San Francisco Peace Treaty came into effect.

2019 On reaching the bottom of the Mariana Trench (the deepest part of the Pacific Ocean) in a submersible, US diver Victor Vescovo found plastic waste.

2001

Space tourist

US millionaire Dennis Tito travelled to the International Space Station (ISS) on board a Russian *Soyuz* spacecraft. He funded the trip himself at a cost of US \$20 million, becoming the first space tourist.



Born this day

1974 Penelope Cruz, Spanish actor. She became an international star after her leading roles in many Spanish-language films.

1947

Kon-Tiki expedition

Norwegian scientist Thor Heyerdahl and his crew of five set sail from Peru for Polynesia on the Kon-Tiki – a raft made of locally available balsa wood. They wanted to prove that ancient South Americans could have travelled the 6,900 km (4,300 miles) to the Polynesian islands.

